Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A112A
Cultures I
Main – All Branches
Midterm Exam

2025-2026/Fall Semester
Date: 19 Nov. 2025
2:30 – 4:30

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 Hours**

INSTRUCTIONS

This Exam consists of **TWO PARTS**.

Part 1 contains **3 Short Answer Questions**. You must choose **TWO** and fully answer them i **PARAGRAPH FORMAT**.

Part 2 contains **2 Essay Questions**. You must choose **ONE** of them and fully answer it in **ESSAY FORMAT**.

Write the question number next to each answer.

Do not answer more questions than required.

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Part 1: Short Answer Questions
(10 points = 5 points for each answer)

Please choose TWO of the following questions and respond to them in paragraph format. Each answer should be approximately 80 words long, addressing all relevant aspects of the question with appropriate evidence from the course material. Ensure that each paragraph includes a clear topic sentence, supporting details, and a conclusion.

1. What was the **'Athenian Agora,'** and what **activities** took place there in ancient times?
2. What does the word **'Panhellenic'** mean in ancient Greece?
3. According to **Pliny**, what are the **key characteristics** of the **'Domus Aurea'**? Do you think that Pliny's description of the palace is **accurate** and **objective**?

Part 2: Essay Questions
(20 points)

Please choose ONE of the essay prompts below and write a comprehensive response in essay format. Your essay should be around 350 words, covering all relevant aspects of the question and backed by evidence from the course material. Make sure to structure your essay with an introduction, multiple body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

4. In ancient Athens, only **male citizens** held full **legal** and **political rights**, while **women**, **foreigners (metics)**, and **enslaved people** were excluded from many aspects of public life. Analyze how the **roles** and **rights** of Athenian citizens differed from those of women, metics, and slaves, both in public and private life. How did these differences reflect the values and structure of Athenian society?

   Use these questions to help structure your essay and ensure all required aspects are covered:

   a. What rights and responsibilities did male Athenian citizens have in political, legal, and military life?
   b. How were women's roles defined in Athenian society, and what were their limitations in both public and private life?
   c. What legal status did metics have, and how were they involved in the city's economy and daily life?
   d. What roles did enslaved people play in Athenian households and society, and what rights, if any, did they possess?
   e. How did these distinctions between citizens and non-citizens help maintain Athenian social order and identity?

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5. Explain the importance of the **Great Fire of Rome in 64 CE** and its aftermath. Discuss how **Nero** used the burned land to build his **Domus Aurea** and how this project affected Roman society.

Use these questions to help structure your essay and ensure all required aspects are covered:

a. What happened during the Great Fire of Rome in 64 CE, and why was it significant?
b. How did Nero take advantage of the destroyed land to build his Domus Aurea? What did this reveal about his goals?
c. What were the key features of the Domus Aurea (according to the descriptions of Pliny the Elder, Suetonius, and Tacitus), and how did they reflect Nero's artistic and architectural style?
d. How did the Roman people react to Nero's expensive and extravagant palace?
e. What long-term effects did the Domus Aurea have on Roman society and culture?

End of the Exam!

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